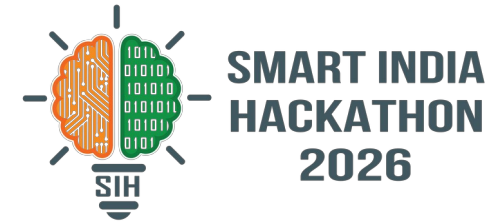


SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026



TITLE PAGE

- **Problem Statement ID** – 26169
- **Problem Statement Title** – AI-Based Virtual Camera Tracking System for Coarse Alignment of Mobile FSOC Terminals
- **Theme** – Smart Automation
- **PS Category** – Software
- **Team ID** – —
- **Team Name** – ZeroDrift

The problem in one line: a mobile laser (FSOC) terminal must find, verify and continuously point at its partner's beacon with hair-thin accuracy — ISRO asks for this coarse-alignment brain, proven entirely in software.





IDEA TITLE

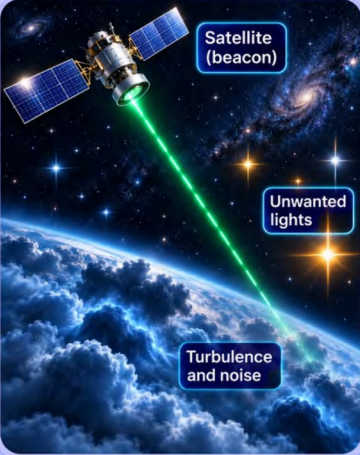
- ❖ Proposed Solution (Describe your Idea/Solution/Prototype)
- Detailed explanation of the proposed solution
- How it addresses the problem
- Innovation and uniqueness of the solution

Problem in one line: find the partner's blinking beacon among stars and glints, verify it, and hold it centred to micro-radian accuracy — automatically, in software.

Our answer — the eyes & neck of a laser terminal: simulate the sky · verify the beacon · track & predict. Built, measured, live.

Simulate

Create a realistic virtual sky



Verify

Identify the correct beacon

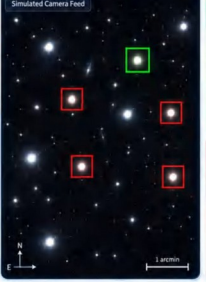
Blinking Beacon Detection

Identify the true beacon among bright objects using temporal blinking signatures

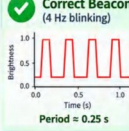
1 Camera Feed
(from simulation)

2 Detected Candidates
(bright objects)

3 Blinking Signature
(analyze brightness over time)



Correct Beacon
(4 Hz blinking)



Period = 0.25 s

Bright Decoy
(rejected)



No 4 Hz pattern

Use temporal blinking signatures to distinguish the true beacon from bright decoys.

Track & Predict

Keep the target centered





1.27 s

median acquisition · 64 runs



98.3 %

lock held · featured demo run



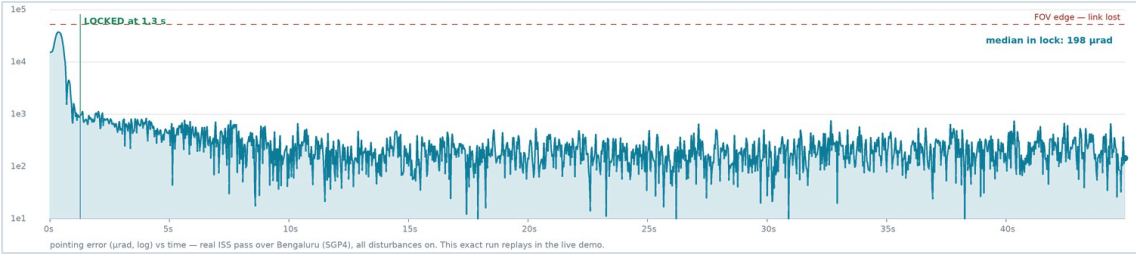
0/64

wrong-target locks



Our console locked on the beacon — the exact view the live demo link opens

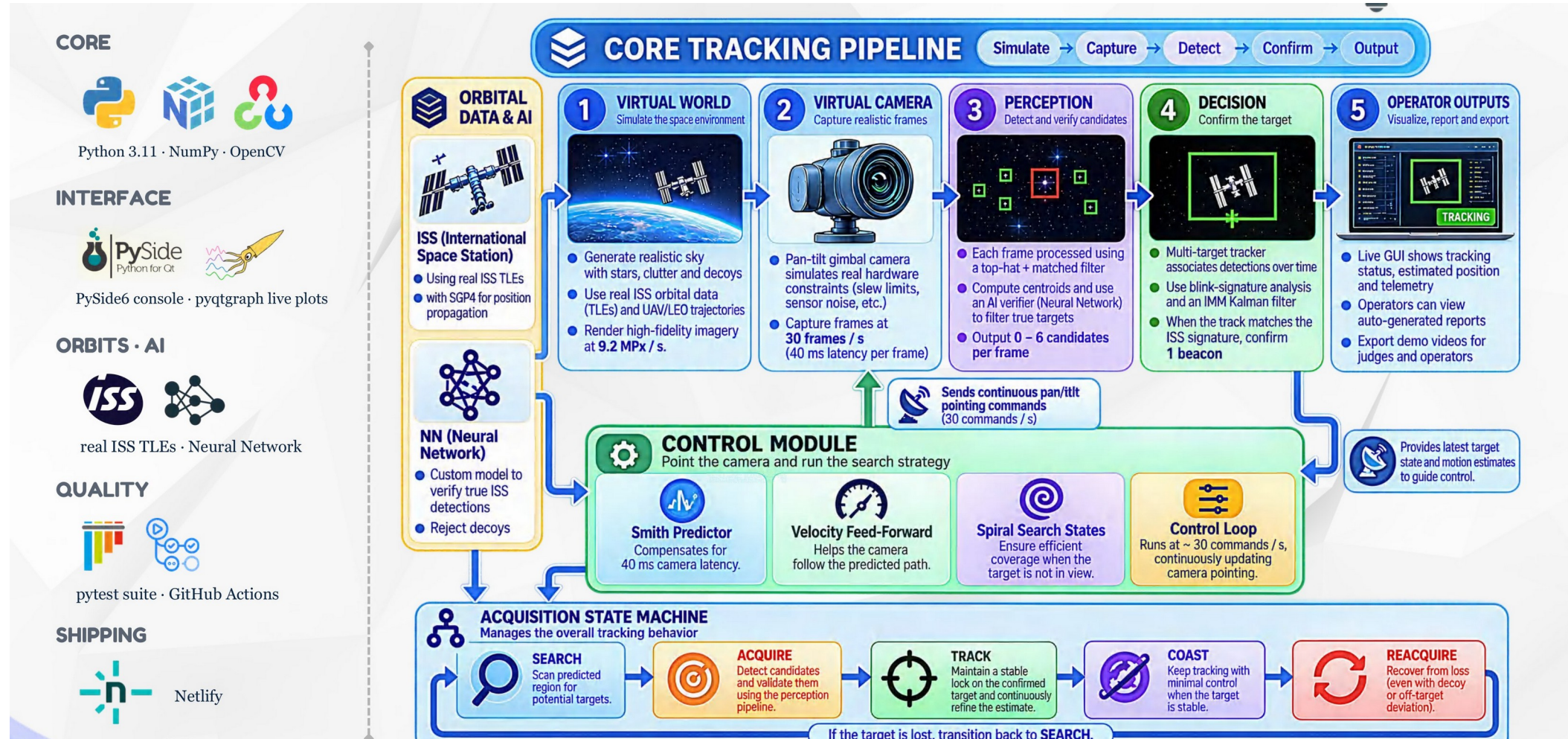
Measured: median 198 μ rad in lock · in-FOV 100% · the live-demo run



Team ZeroDrift · SIH 2026 · PS 26169

2

- Technologies to be used (e.g. programming languages, frameworks, hardware)
- Methodology and process for implementation (Flow Charts/Images/ working prototype)



- Analysis of the feasibility of the idea
- Potential challenges and risks



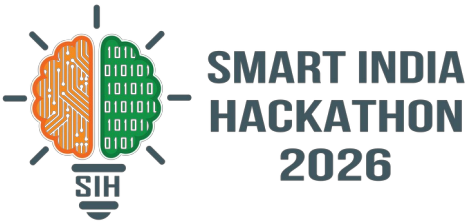
Worst case, 64 runs → never a wrong lock, never a failed acquisition.



Reproducible: every number regenerates from one command.



IMPACT AND BENEFITS



- Potential impact on the target audience
- Benefits of the solution (social, economic, environmental, etc.)

ECONOMIC FEASIBILITY — the arithmetic that removes the cost barrier

CAPITAL COST TO START DEVELOPING

Hardware PAT test bench

₹15–50 lakh

Machine-vision camera + encoder gimbal + fast steering mirror + beacon optics + isolation table + turbulence cell

ZeroDrift

₹0

Runs CPU-only on a laptop the team already owns — no GPU, no cloud, no purchased dataset

₹0.22

Electricity for a complete 64-run validation campaign

0.0279 kWh measured × ₹8/kWh. Per single run: ₹0.0035

207×

Faster than a hardware bench over the same 64-condition sweep

37 minutes measured, against ~16 working days of lab reconfiguration

₹15 cr

Hardware needed to equip 100 researchers independently

ZeroDrift equips the same hundred for nothing

₹15 crore vs ₹0

STRATEGIC IMPACT

- Advances India’s next-generation space & defence communications
- Sovereign FSOC algorithms
- Less imported hardware

RESEARCH & EDUCATION

- Any student or ISRO lab can develop, test and compare PAT algorithms instantly
- Reproducible scenarios, honest ground-truth scoring, open source

ECONOMIC IMPACT

- A laptop replaces lakhs of rupees of cameras, gimbals and optics
- Software-based testing
- Zero recurring cost

SCALABLE & GREEN

- Same engine covers satellite, UAV, ground and maritime links
- Pure software- no consumables, no lab energy, no e-waste in the development cycle.

Target audience

ISRO

DRDO Teams

IITs & engineering colleges

space-tech startups

Optical Link Close Ratethe number that matters

ZeroDrift coarse + modelled fine stage

99.3%

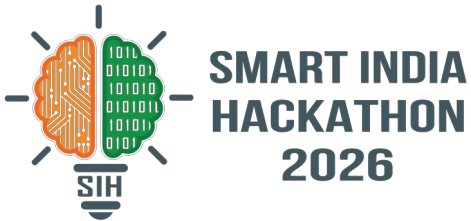
Coarse stage alone — the gap we close

14.7%

same tracked ISS pass, identical channel · mean margin 3.1 dB · docs/technical_report.md



RESEARCH AND REFERENCES



• *Details / Links of the reference and research work*

Research foundations

Kaymak et al., “A Survey on Acquisition, Tracking and Pointing Mechanisms for Mobile FSO,” IEEE Comm. Surveys & Tutorials, 2018. [\[link\]](#)

Kaushal & Kaddoum, “Optical Communication in Space: Challenges and Mitigation Techniques,” IEEE CS&T, 2017. [\[link\]](#)

Blackman & Popoli, Design and Analysis of Modern Tracking Systems — IMM filtering, CFAR detection. [\[link\]](#)

Bar-Shalom et al., Estimation with Applications to Tracking and Navigation — Kalman/IMM theory. [\[link\]](#)

Smith, O.J.M., “Closer Control of Loops with Dead Time” — the Smith predictor, 1957. [\[link\]](#)

Vallado & Crawford, “SGP4 Orbit Determination” — AIAA 2008; real ISS TLE propagation. [\[link\]](#)

Andrews & Phillips, Laser Beam Propagation through Random Media — turbulence & scintillation. [\[link\]](#)

Our work — open and verifiable

Repository: github.com/pranshukesavmishra/SIH-2026

Live demo (replay console): zerodrift-fsoc-pat.netlify.app

Inside: 5,500+ documented lines · 83 automated tests · 6 validated scenarios · Monte-Carlo logs · technical report · user manual · demo video.

Reproducible: every figure regenerates from one command; every random draw is logged and replayable.

Compared with existing approaches

Compared with existing approaches			
Feature	ZERO+DRIFT	MATLAB sim	Traditional
Zero hardware cost No special equipment required	✓	✓	✗
Real-time closed loop + live console See it run. Live.	✓	✗	✓
Decoy & blink-signature discrimination Robust against spoofing	✓	✗	✗
Open source + one-command reproducible Run with a single command	✓	✗	✗

Why ZeroDrift wins on this problem

- ✓ All six mandatory deliverables already exist today
- ✓ Judged numbers, honestly measured against hidden ground truth
- ✓ AI where it earns its place — benchmarked against classical methods

